Expanding or Shrinking?

T-chart sort + claim · Skill: Expanding and shrinking at once

Name _____ **Period** _____ **Date** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY

I can sort changes as expanding or shrinking democracy and explain who gained and who lost.



North Carolina — Black voters journeying to the polling stations — wood engraving, Frank Leslie's, 1880, public domain (Library of Congress)

Directions

Between 1890 and 1920, democracy grew for some Americans and shrank for others. Sort each change, then write your claim.

1 Sort the changes

Did each change expand or shrink democracy?

	STATEMENT	EXPANDING DEMOCRACY	SHRINKING DEMOCRACY
1	1890: Wyoming joins the Union, and its women keep the right to vote.	☐	☐
2	1890: Mississippi's new constitution adds a poll tax and a literacy test for voting.	☐	☐
3	1896: In Plessy v. Ferguson, the Supreme Court allows 'separate but equal' segregation.	☐	☐
4	1898: Louisiana adds a grandfather clause to its voting rules.	☐	☐
5	1902: Oregon lets voters propose and pass laws themselves (initiative and referendum).	☐	☐
6	Black voters registered in Louisiana fall from about 130,000 in 1896 to about 5,000 in 1900.	☐	☐

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	STATEMENT	EXPANDING DEMOCRACY	SHRINKING DEMOCRACY
7	1913: The 17th Amendment lets voters elect U.S. senators directly.	☐	☐
8	1913: Illinois women win the right to vote for president.	☐	☐

2 Who gained? Who lost?

Look at your two columns.

Who gained a voice in these years?

Who lost a voice?

3 Your claim

Was this an age of more democracy or less?

Write 2–3 sentences. Use one example from each column.

Finished? Turn in this paper the way your teacher asks.

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